

Pownal Bay

Shoreline length: 33 km



Shore Types

Pownal Bay is located on the southeast end of PEI. Shore type characterized by a majority of wetlands.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
13	4	1	8	74	0	0	0



Bluff off Earnscliffe road south of Pownal Bay



Cherrycliff Park and Earnscliffe beach



Coastal wetlands along Cherry Valley

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

This area is unincorporated. Infrastructure includes Pownal Road (Route 26, at Mount Albion Creek).

There are no key coastal economic drivers within the coastal section of this region. Local and legacy land use constraints include several small

undeveloped lots, accessed by unpaved or undeveloped coastal roads.

Natural Assets and Heritage

There are two main recreation assets: Cherrycliff Park (playground and beach access) and the Pownal Sports Centre (double ice pad, a 600-seat stadium, a 150-seat arena, and community rooms).

The shoreline includes critical habitat for bird species including the threatened Bank Swallow.

Planning and Policy Framework

Provincial rules apply. Land use and development is managed under provincial development standards, which include horizontal coastal building setbacks based on edge of feature and a calculation of erosion over time, building setbacks for dunes, and a requirement for a coastal buffer for new subdivisions. There are no specific flood elevations identified in regulations, but coastal hazard assessments are typically conducted.

Proposed SMP Strategies

The primary strategy for Pownal Bay is No Active Intervention. In areas where infrastructure is at risk, managed realignment and resist are options.

	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
Sea level rise range	0 – 0.3 m	0.3 – 0.6 m	0.6 – 1.2 m
Potential timeframe	2030 - 2050	2050 - 2080	2080 - 2130
Proposed SMU strategy	NAI	NAI	NAI
Rationale	The local shoreline and hazard zone should remain natural, undeveloped.		

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

Infrastructure within in this area are vulnerable to increasing flood hazards. Erosion hazard is highest along the west facing cliffs with limited development. The following flood risk indicator is based on the even with 1% annual exceedance probability (100-year return) with increasing amounts of sea level rise (SLR). The erosion risk indicator is based on potential shoreline change or salt marsh migration to future time horizons.

Number of at-risk buildings [N. per km shoreline]

	Present	0.3m SLR (2050)	0.6m SLR (2080)	1.2m SLR (2130)
SMU Pownal Bay				
Flood risk	0 [<1/km]	0 [<1/km]	1 [<1/km]	4 [<1/km]
Erosion risk	NA	2 [<1/km]	3 [<1/km]	10 [<1/km]

Sediment transport - The estimated net sediment transport rate averaged across the SMU is low.



LEGEND - Shoreline Management Unit - Net Longshore Sediment Transport - High Hazard Area - Flood Extent - Present Day (100-year Return) - Flood Extent - 1.2m SLR (100-year Return) - Property Boundary - Building > 90ft²	 0 245 490 980 Metres Coordinate System: NAD 83 CSRS PEI Double Stereographic NOTES:		COASTAL EROSION AND FLOOD HAZARD Shoreline Management Unit: Pownal Bay	<i>Prince Edward Island</i> Île-du-Prince-Édouard
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